LESSON 3

Mary had a little lamb

A rhyme by Sarah Josepha Hale, first printed in Boston in 1830, about a lamb that followed a girl to school. We sing it to the tune of *Merrily we roll along*.

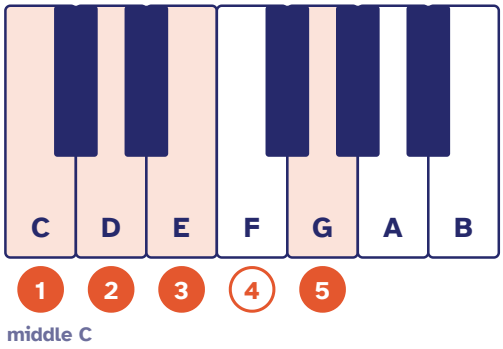
IN THIS SONG **4/4** **four notes: C D E G** **the C position** **steps and a skip**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

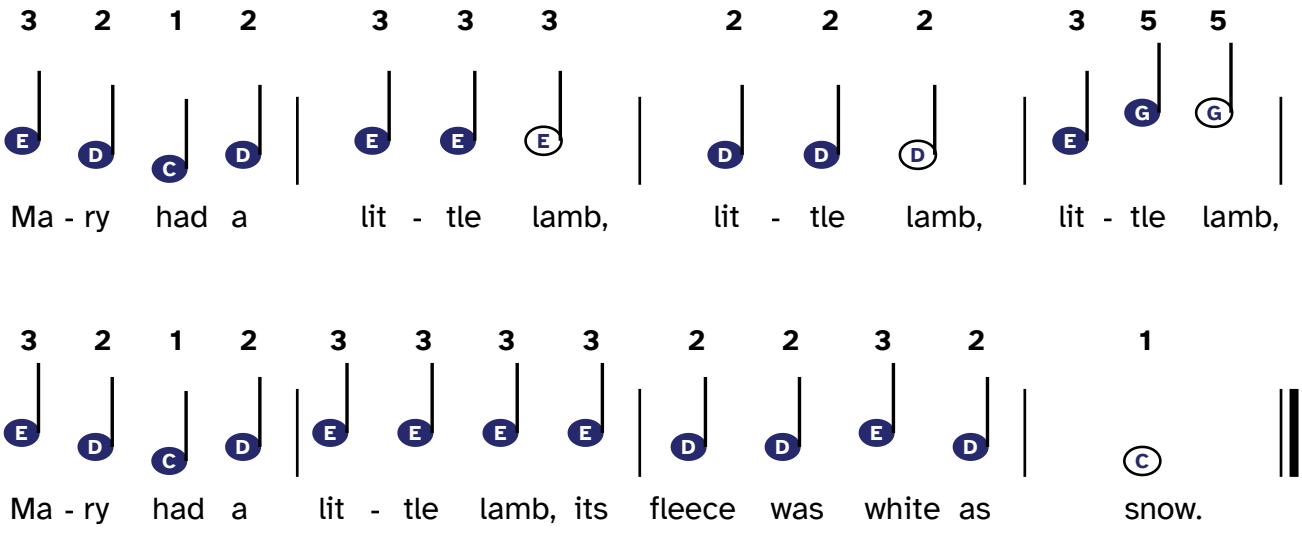
THE WOW MOMENT
Spooky Mary. Keep your hand where it is and play every E one key lower, on the black key E♭ (finger 3 slides down). The same song turns dark: C minor, your first spooky music.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words.



Your hand: C position. Right thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G. The song's notes are lit.
Steps and a skip. Most notes move by a step, to the next key. Only once does the tune skip a key: E up to G.



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

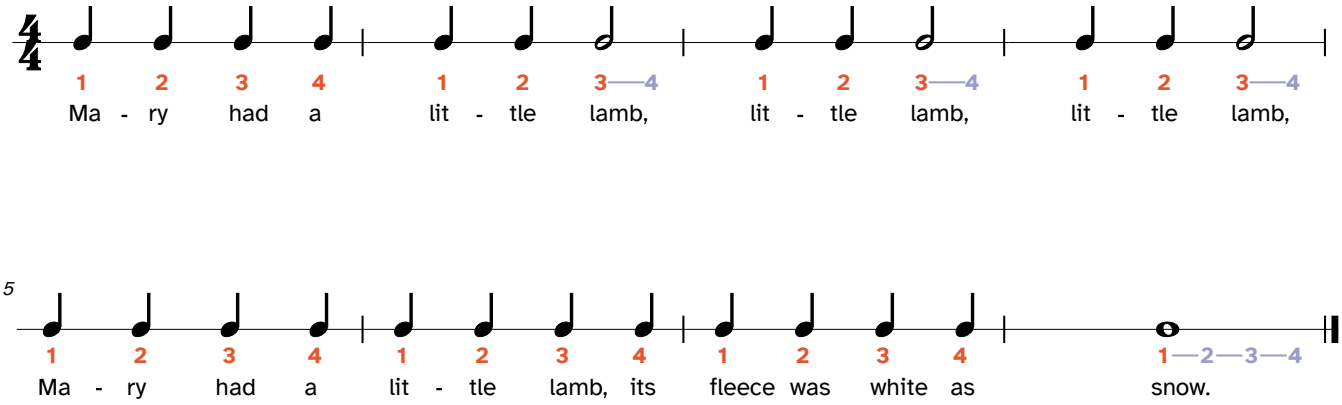
4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

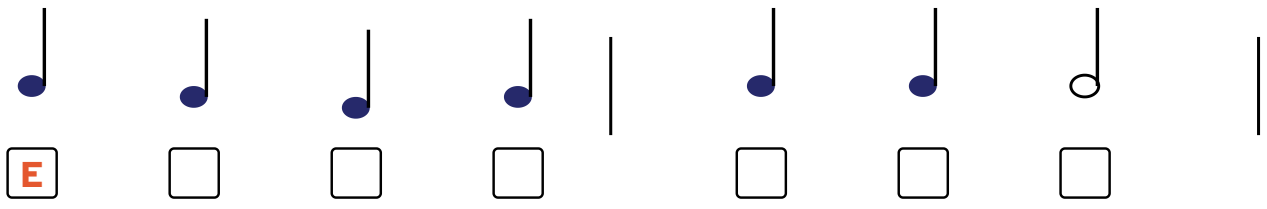


crotchet — 1 beat ●
minim — 2 beats ●●
semibreve — 4 beats ●●●●

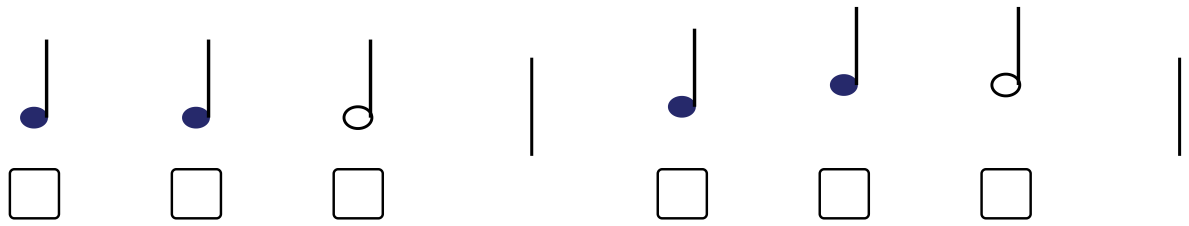


THE NOTES

Write the letter name of every note in the first four bars; the first one is done. Then find the skip: in which bar does the tune jump from E up to G? ☐



3



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

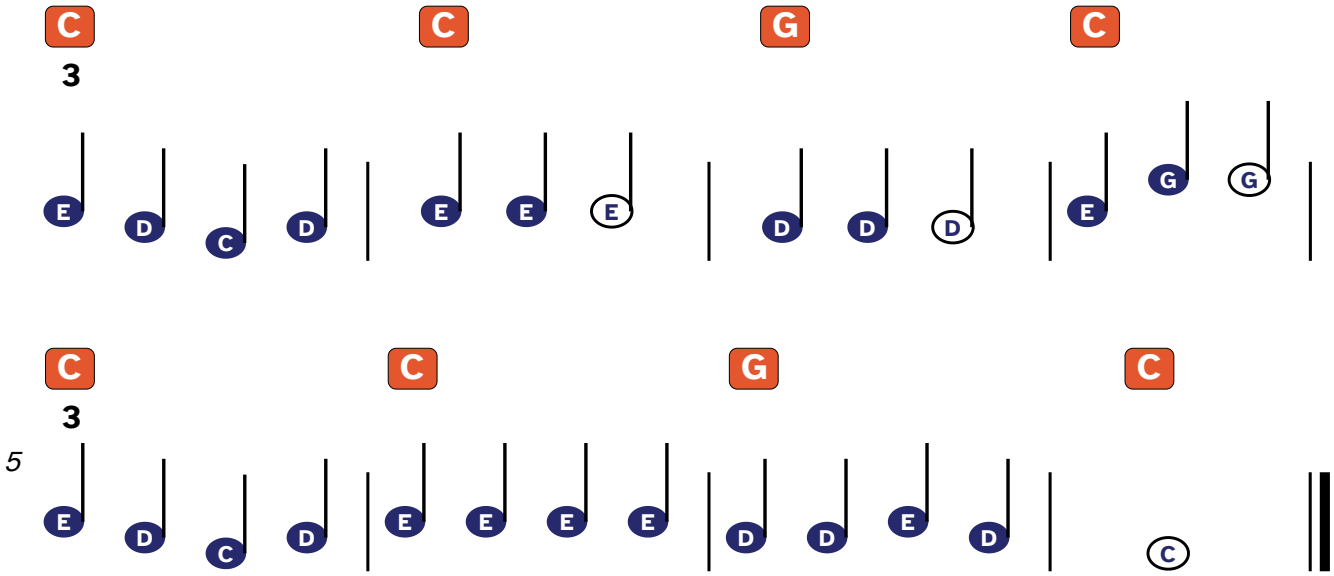
3 Lead sheet

The tune, with only the chord names above it. Two names in this song: C and G.

THE NAMES

A name tells the band which chord to play under the tune. Your left hand learns to play them from Lesson 4.

C G



1 Circle every G

2 Play the tune with the band (the listening page): the band plays the names

3 Say the names out loud in time while the band plays

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words

☐ I can find the skip, E up to G

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the band				

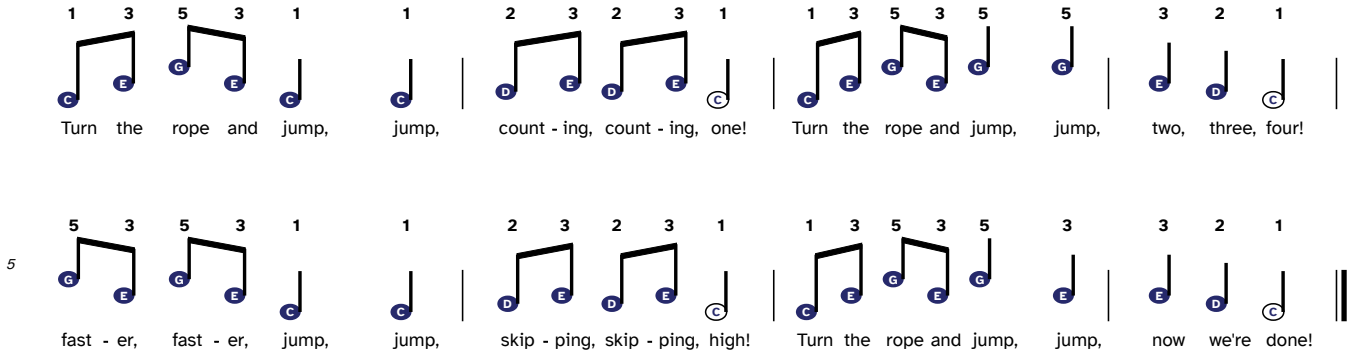
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

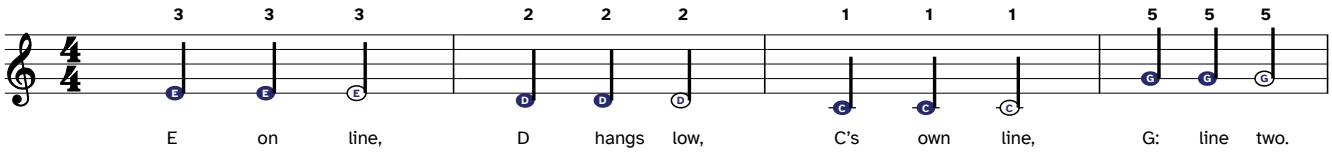
JUMP ROPE

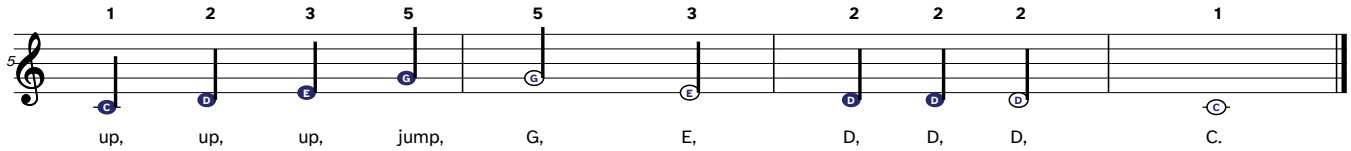
Bouncy and quick: the four keys with skips, C E G, like a rope going round. Keep the running notes light.



HELLO, STAFF

Calm and careful, a peek at Lesson 4: the same notes on five lines. E sits on the bottom line, D hangs below it, C has a little line of its own, G sits on line two.





MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- [ ] **Spooky: every E becomes E♭, finger 3 on the black key**
- [ ] **Skipping: light and bouncy, like Mary's lamb**
- [ ] **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Lead sheet: the tune with the band
4. Spooky Mary, with E♭

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S